



The handy phone toolkit

Turn your phone into a swiss army knife of digital life

Utility apps rarely make headlines. They're the quiet backbone of smartphone productivity – the tools that clean up the clutter, automate the routine, and quietly solve the annoyances we face every day.

In this chapter, we shine a light on 10 underrated yet indispensable free utilities that turn your phone into a truly all-purpose companion – from document scanning and password management to automation, remote control, and even beautifying your home screen. These are apps you'll quickly start using daily and wonder how you ever managed without them.

1. PhotoScan by Google Photos

Platforms: Android, iOS

Flawless photo digitization without glare or blur. You've seen those half-baked "scan your photo" apps – but none come close to PhotoScan, Google's ingenious tool for turning printed memories into perfect digital copies. Instead of just snapping a flat photo, PhotoScan guides you to take five angled shots, then stitches them together automatically to remove glare, correct perspective, and enhance clarity.

The result: beautifully restored digital photos, ready to archive, share, or back up to Google Photos. Whether you're